

SCIENCE • GRADE 3

Basic Needs of Living Things



THINK • WONDER • SHARE

Let's Explore!

“What does a dog need to stay alive?”

“What does a plant need to grow?”

Look closely. Think quietly. Then share your idea with a partner!

What Are Basic Needs?

Living things need certain things from their environment to survive and grow.



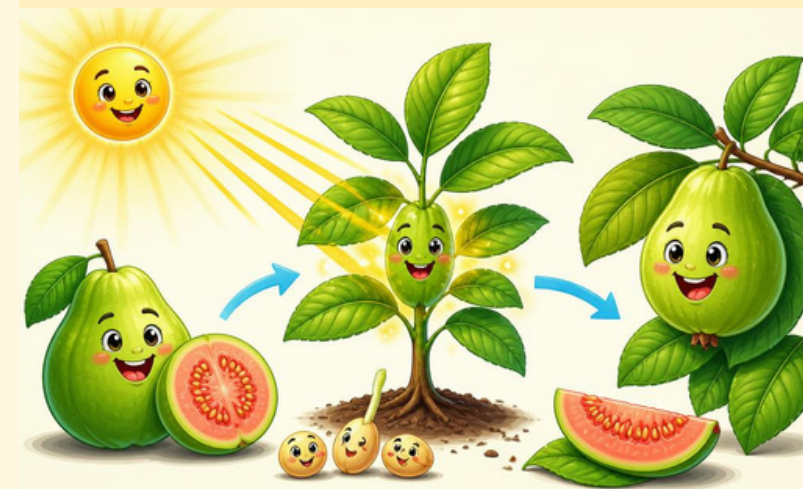
AIR

for life
processes



WATER

for survival and
growth



FOOD

energy for
animals; plants
make their own



SPACE / SHELTER

a safe place to live
and grow

COMPARE

Different Living Things Need Different Things



DOG

air • water • food
• shelter



BIRD

air • water • food
• shelter



PLANT

air • water •
sunlight • space



FISH

water • food •
suitable space

LOOK CLOSER

Living Things in Their Habitats



Dog: food, water & shelter

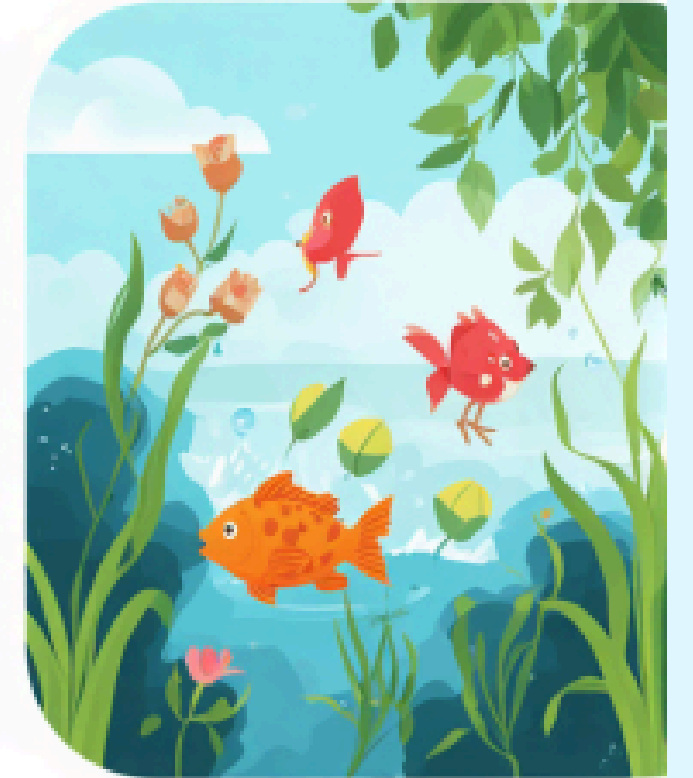
Bird: nest, air & food

Plant: sunlight, water & soil

Fish: water, food & space

FIND • DRINK • EAT • REST

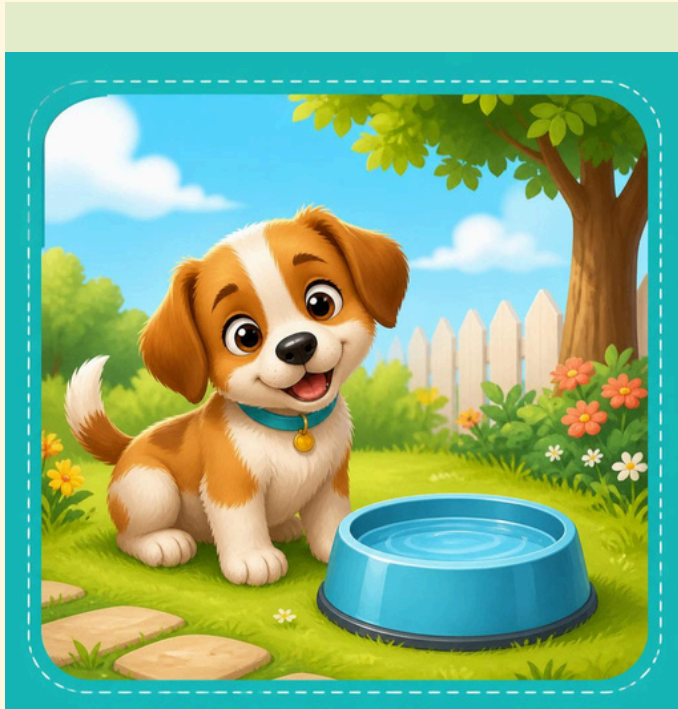
How Animals Get Their Needs



Animals find food, water, and shelter in their environment to stay alive and safe.

YES OR NO?

What Does It Need?



Dog + clean
water

YES / NO



Plant + water

YES / NO



Fish + dry land

YES / NO



Bird + food

YES / NO



Plant + no
space

YES / NO

Does this living thing need this? Point, vote, and explain!

SHOW WHAT YOU
KNOW

Assessment Questions

1. Which is a basic need?

- A Water B Television
C Toy D Computer game

3. Why is space or shelter needed?

- A Survival and growth
B Become nonliving
C Stop growing D Change into
objects

2. What gives animals energy?

- A Food B Toys
C Books D Clothes

4. Which does a plant need?

- A Water B Television
C Shoes D Toys

5. NOT a basic need of a dog?

- A Food B Water
C Shelter D Video game

GREAT THINKING!

Assessment Answer Key



1 • A — Water



2 • A — Food



3 • A — Supports survival and growth



4 • A — Water



5 • D — Video game

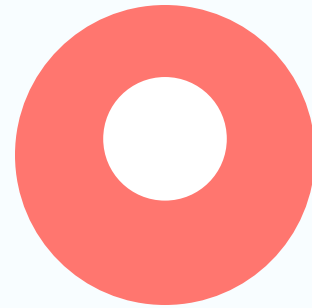
REMEMBER THESE

Key Takeaways



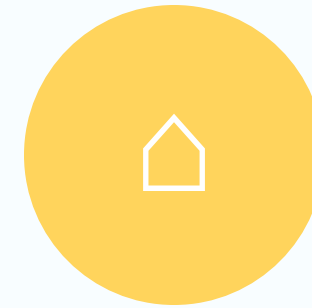
AIR

Living things need
air for life.



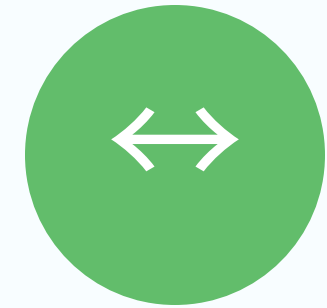
WATER + FOOD

Water supports
life. Food gives
animals energy.



SPACE / SHELTER

A safe, suitable
place helps living
things grow.



DIFFERENT NEEDS

Needs can change
with each living
thing and habitat.

THINK • SHARE • DRAW

Review and Reflect

What do you think your pet or favorite plant needs to live and grow?

Share your idea — or draw your answer for the class!



Thank You — Keep Exploring!

Thank you for learning about the basic needs of living things! Keep exploring and discovering the amazing world around you!